first time a side of him [Don] he hadn't seen—an outburst of temper. Finally, [Don] snarled he'd be out of here Monday or Tuesday."

That evening, I asked Paul Laxalt to come to the White House and told him I'd like him to take on the White House job. But he said he might make a run for the presidency and didn't want to take himself out of the running by taking the job. "His candidate," I wrote, "is former Senator Howard Baker. It's not a bad idea. He thinks Howard is looking for a graceful way of getting out of running for president. I'd probably take some lumps from our right wingers, but I can handle that. . ."

The entry for February 26 continued: "VP just came up—another meeting with Don. This time totally different. He says he'll hand in his resignation first thing Monday morning. My prayers have really been answered."

Another prayer was answered later the same day during a telephone conversation with Howard Baker. "Howard was in Florida visiting his grandchildren. When he called back I asked him to take the job. Paul was right. He accepted immediately and is coming to Washington tomorrow . . ."

This diary entry concluded: "Now I'll go on reading the Tower report till I fall asleep . . ."

During our meeting the week before, Don Regan had said he would remain on the job until I found a replacement for him; then I would announce his resignation and the name of his successor and the date of the change. Unfortunately, there was a news leak, and it became public that I intended to replace Don with Howard Baker. The leak was not intentional, and I had not wanted to embarrass Don.

The next thing I knew, Kathy Osborne sent an envelope to me at the residence (it was almost 6:00 P.M.) that contained a single sheet of paper. It said:

> I resign as Chief of Staff to the President of the United States.